



Martin Luther King Jr Extraordinary Lives

Comprehension Questions

1. What name was Martin Luther King given when he was born?

2. Why did his father change both of their names?

3. What childhood memory had a lasting impact on King?

4. How did King's father inspire him?

5. Who else did King find inspiring? Why?

6. What surprised King about living in the integrated north of the USA?

7. Which landmark court case took place in 1954?

8. What was Claudette Colvin arrested for in 1955?

9. What was the motto of the SCLC?



10. What were the dangers of being a civil rights figurehead?

11. Why is the March on Washington considered to be so important?

12. What lasting impact do you think Martin Luther King has?

13. How do you think King would perceive the Black Lives Matter movement?



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Comprehension Question Answers

1. What name was Martin Luther King given when he was born?

Michael

2. Why did his father change both of their names?

He was inspired by learning about Protestant theologian Martin Luther during a visit to Germany.

3. What childhood memory had a lasting impact on King?

Being told that he could no longer play with a white friend.

4. How did King's father inspire him?

Any of the following: he was a pastor who denounced segregation and led civil rights marches; educated King about the history of slavery; encouraged his son to practise a non-violent philosophy.

5. Who else did King find inspiring? Why?

Mahatma Gandhi and his philosophy of satyagraha, which also promoted non-violence.

6. What surprised King about living in the integrated north of the USA?

King was surprised at the freedom Black people experienced where they could occupy the same spaces as whites.

7. Which landmark court case took place in 1954?

Brown vs Board of Education.

8. What was Claudette Colvin arrested for in 1955?

Answers could include: refusing to give up her seat; disturbing the peace; breaking segregation laws; battery; assault of a police officer.

9. What was the motto of the SCLC?

Not one hair of one head of one white person shall be harmed.

10. What were the dangers of being a civil rights figurehead?

Answers could include: threats, violence, intimidation, bombings, shootings, stabbing, a burning cross outside of King's home, arrests, surveillance.

11. Why is the March on Washington considered to be so important?

Answers could include: it was a successful peaceful process that was broadcast to millions around the world; it demonstrated the inequality of life in the USA and is considered to have been a catalyst in driving legal changes, e.g. the Voting Rights Act 1965 and the Fair Housing Act 1968, changes to immigration reform, the war on poverty and Medicare and Medicaid.

12. What lasting impact do you think Martin Luther King has?

Answers are subjective; please credit any valid and well argued opinion.

13. How do you think King would perceive the Black Lives Matter movement?

Answers are subjective; please credit any valid and well argued opinion.